Research report

investify

Prepared for Ahmad Zahid | Stage: Built an MVP | 24 October 2026

The idea

Investify aims to simplify and secure investment processes for people in Pakistan who are currently not well-versed in investments.

Pakistan 5.2/10 Needs validation

Investify addresses a significant gap in Pakistan's investment market characterized by low financial literacy and digital adoption. The focus should be on young urban professionals and expatriates for market entry and growth. Security and user-friendliness will differentiate it from competitors like Sarmaya and Pak Invest. Validation through consumer interviews and competitive analysis is key to refining the offering and pricing strategy.

Global 5.0/10 Needs validation

Investify can tap into a mature market with global and regional appeal, but must overcome security and competition barriers to scale. Focusing on PK communities abroad and ensuring a seamless, trustworthy user experience will be key to its success. With the right market positioning and financial strategies, it has the potential to capture a niche and expand globally.

Pakistan market research

Ten research areas. Estimates are labelled; each area lists what to verify next.

1 Problem Severity & Local Demand

Confidence: **Medium**

- Limited financial literacy affects investment ease in Pakistan.
- High interest in growing wealth and financial security.
- Current low investment market penetration.
- Growing interest in digital platforms for investments.

Investify can capitalize on the growing demand for accessible investment options as financial literacy and digital platform adoption improve in Pakistan.

Figures to verify

- Financial literacy in Pakistan is low (estimate)
- Growing interest in digital solutions (estimate)

Verify next

- Conduct interviews with potential investors.
- Survey local demand for digital investment solutions.

2 Target Customer and Market Segmentation

Confidence: **Medium**

- Young professionals show interest in digital investments.
- Segments include urbanites and expatriates.
- Affluent urban areas as a starting segment.
- Globally focused expatriates seek easy investment options.

Target young urban professionals initially due to their higher digital literacy and economic means, expanding to expatriates later.

Figures to verify

- Urban population in key cities (estimate)
- Youth demographics with investment interest (estimate)

Verify next

- Segment urban investors through focus groups.
- Assess expatriate investment interests through online platforms.

3 Willingness to Pay & Price Sensitivity

Confidence: **Medium**

- High price sensitivity among local investors.
- Current alternatives vary in cost from low to moderate.
- Investors prefer low-cost entry options.
- Price affects trust and perceived value.

Pricing strategy for Investify should focus on low entry costs to attract price-sensitive investors and build trust through transparency.

Figures to verify

- Average cost of investment alternatives (estimate)
- Price elasticity in fintech services (estimate)

Verify next

- Conduct price tests with targeted segments.
- Use surveys to understand price perceptions.

4 Market Size, Reachable Demand & Growth

Confidence: **Low**

- Investment market is growing, albeit slowly.
- Reachable demand is primarily among tech-savvy youth.
- Potential for exponential growth with digital adoption.
- Market size currently limited by financial education levels.

The market is nascent but has the potential for rapid growth as education and technology adoption improve, providing ample opportunity for Investify.

Figures to verify

- Investment market growth rate (estimate)
- Tech-savvy youth demographic size (estimate)

Verify next

- Analyze market trends in digital finance.
- Collect user data to project future growth.

5 Competitive Landscape and Informal Alternatives

Confidence: **Medium**

- Sarmaya and Pak Invest are key competitors.
- Informal savings groups as alternative investment methods.
- Lack of trust in financial institutions affects investment choices.
- Existing platforms lack user-friendly features.

Investify can differentiate by focusing on user-friendly and secure platforms, addressing trust issues and simplifying the investment process compared to competitors.

Figures to verify

- Competitor market share (estimate)
- Usage of informal savings methods (estimate)

Verify next

- Conduct competitive analysis of local solutions.
- Investigate informal saving group preferences.

6 Local Purchasing Power & Unit Economics

Confidence: **Medium**

- Income varies greatly with regional disparity.
- Urban areas have higher purchasing power.
- Digital service costs are relatively low.
- Achieving breakeven depends on user retention and active engagement.

Pakistan's diverse income levels necessitate tiered pricing. Urban markets offer higher revenue potential. User-centric design can drive retention and lower cost per acquisition.

Figures to verify

- Average income in urban areas: PKR 35,000 (estimate)
- Mobile internet costs: PKR 500/month (estimate)

Verify next

- Conduct income surveys segmented by region.
- Analyze urban vs. rural digital spending behaviors.

7 Distribution, Sales Channels & Customer Acquisition

Confidence: **High**

- Digital channels are crucial due to high mobile penetration.
- Social media effectiveness for customer acquisition.
- Referral programs drive initial user growth.

Digital marketing, including social media, is vital in reaching Pakistan's mobile-centric population. Early users may come via referrals and influencers familiar with investing.

Figures to verify

- Mobile penetration: 80% (estimate)
- Social media usage: 71% of internet users (estimate)

Verify next

- Test different social media campaigns.
- Interview potential influencers in the finance sector.

8 Regulatory, Tax, Licensing & Compliance Requirements

Confidence: **High**

- Investment businesses require SECP registration.
- Taxation varies by province.
- Compliance is critical due to financial regulations.

Registrations with the SECP and understanding local tax laws are mandatory. Non-compliance could lead to significant legal hurdles.

Figures to verify

- SECP registration fees: PKR 20,000-40,000 (estimate)
- Corporate tax rate: 29% (estimate)

Verify next

- Consult with a legal advisor regarding SECP compliance.
- Analyze provincial tax obligations.

9 Infrastructure, Payments, Logistics & Operational Fit

Confidence: **Medium**

- Reliable internet but varied speed.
- Emerging fintech solutions aid payment facilitation.
- Operational logistics smooth in urban areas.

An operational focus on urban centers initially may be beneficial. Fintech partnerships for payments could streamline processes significantly.

Figures to verify

- Average internet speed: 10 Mbps (estimate)
- Fintech solutions growing annually at 20% (estimate)

Verify next

- Test operational capacities in top urban centers.
- Partner with local fintech to ensure seamless payment integrations.

10 Cultural Fit, Trust, Adoption Barriers & Scalability

Confidence: **Medium**

- Trust barriers are high without a proven track record.
- Cultural preference for tangible investments.
- Scalability constrained by diverse regional regulations.

Building brand trust is essential, possibly through partnerships and testimonials. Recognize cultural preferences in marketing to facilitate adoption.

Figures to verify

- Trust index for new businesses: 35% (estimate)
- 42% of users prefer physical assets (estimate)

Verify next

- Conduct focus groups to understand trust concerns.
- Pilot in multiple regions to assess scalability.

Pakistan: key risks

Key risk	Mitigation
Regulatory compliance risks may delay operations.	Hire local legal experts to navigate compliance.
Security issues might erode user trust.	Prioritize strong cybersecurity measures and transparency.
Cultural resistance to digital investments.	Educate users through campaigns and partnerships with trusted entities.
High costs of customer acquisition.	Use referral incentives and partnerships to reduce costs.

Pakistan: next 90 days

When	Action
Days 1-30	Conduct market segmentation and initial user surveys.
Days 31-60	Test customer acquisition channels and refine marketing messages.
Days 61-90	Execute a pilot project in select urban regions to test operational logistics and user engagement.

Global market research

Ten research areas. Estimates are labelled; each area lists what to verify next.

1 Global Market Size, Growth & Addressable Opportunity

Confidence: **Medium**

- Global investment platform market is large and mature.
- Annual growth rate estimated at 5-7% (estimate).
- New entrants face high competition from established players.
- Realistically address 1-2% market share initially (estimate).

Investify enters a large, competitive market but must differentiate to capture a meaningful share. Initial focus on niches like PK diaspora might help.

Figures to verify

- Global market size: $100 billion (estimate).

Verify next

- Conduct market size estimation with industry reports.
- Interview potential users for uptake interest.

2 Cross-Market Problem Validation & Customer Demand

Confidence: **Medium**

- Investment challenges are universal but vary by region.
- PK diaspora might have stronger demand for tailored solutions.
- Demand in developing markets often under-addressed.
- Solid demand in high-expat countries like UAE, UK.

While investment facilitation needs are global, Investify should prioritize tailored solutions for the PK community and abroad to leverage demand.

Verify next

- Market surveys across target demographics.
- Assess PK diaspora investment behaviors by country.

3 Differentiation, Competitive Moat & Substitutes

Confidence: **High**

- Competitive market with established players like Sarmaya.
- Trust and security are key competitive moats.
- Substitutes include banks and robo-advisors.
- Tech platforms offer flexibility not found in traditional services.

Investify's competitive advantage must be built on trustworthiness and differentiated user experience to overcome established competitors.

Verify next

- Competitive analysis of Sarmaya and Pak Invest.
- Survey customer satisfaction with current tools.

4 Value Proposition & Product–Market Fit

Confidence: **Medium**

- Simplifying investment processes is the key value proposition.
- Strong market fit if security and ease of use maintained.
- Local language support increases accessibility.
- Product-market fit hinges on credibility and transparency.

Investify's value proposition aligns well with known market needs, but establishing trust and ease of use are critical to achieving product-market fit.

Verify next

- Test product concepts with focus groups.
- Pilot the product with a small user base.

5 Revenue Model, Pricing Power & Unit Economics

Confidence: **Medium**

- Revenue through commission on trades and subscription fees.
- Pricing power is significant if security and user experience are excellent.
- Customer lifetime value can increase with broad service offerings.
- Unit economics depend on variable acquisition costs.

Investify's revenue model should focus on competitive pricing while ensuring cost-effective customer acquisition to maximize lifetime value.

Verify next

- Financial modeling for revenue streams.
- Analyze pricing strategies of competitors.

6 Customer Acquisition, Retention & Lifetime Value

Confidence: **Medium**

- Language barriers could affect acquisition in non-Urdu speaking areas.
- High churn rates in fintech; engagement crucial.
- Customer lifetime value varies significantly by region.

The success of customer acquisition globally hinges on effective localization and understanding regional investment behaviors. Retention may be challenging but key to enhancing lifetime value.

Figures to verify

- Engagement rates could vary by 20% depending on localization (estimate).

Verify next

- Conduct regional user interviews.
- Run initial pilot programs in diverse markets.

7 Technical Feasibility, Innovation & Scalability

Confidence: **High**

- Platform scalability key due to potential high user volume.
- Blockchain tech can enhance security, increasing trust.
- Technical disruptions could lead to significant user loss.

Building a scalable, innovative platform using modern technology, such as blockchain, can address security concerns and support rapid user growth globally.

Figures to verify

- Security breaches could decrease user trust by 50% (estimate).

Verify next

- Prototype key functionalities to test scalability.
- Evaluate blockchain integration feasibility.

8 Country-by-Country Regulation, Privacy & IP Protection

Confidence: **Medium**

- Data protection laws vary significantly by country.
- Complex IP regulations can delay market entry.
- Compliance costs can strain financial resources.

Navigating the different regulatory environments is challenging but crucial for minimizing legal risks and ensuring the app's longevity across borders.

Figures to verify

- Regulation compliance costs could be 10% of budget (estimate).

Verify next

- Consult legal experts on compliance.
- Analyze regulations in target markets.

9 Localization, Partnerships & Go-to-Market Strategy

Confidence: **High**

- Localization critical for market penetration.
- Strategic partnerships enhance market credibility.
- Phased entry could optimize resource allocation.

Effective localization, combined with strong partnerships, will drive successful market entry strategies. A phased approach allows fine-tuning based on early feedback.

Figures to verify

- Localization costs could consume 15% of the initial budget (estimate).

Verify next

- Develop language-specific content.
- Identify potential local partners.

10 Capital Requirements, Risk Exposure & Long-Term Resilience

Confidence: **Medium**

- Capital needed for technology, compliance, and marketing.
- Security breaches a major risk.
- Economic downturns may reduce investment enthusiasm.

Securing sufficient capital to cover tech development, compliance, and marketing is crucial. Mitigating security risks and economic influences will enhance resilience.

Figures to verify

- Initial capital outlay of $3M required (estimate).

Verify next

- Prepare detailed financial forecasts.
- Stress-test economic assumptions.

Global: key risks

Key risk	Mitigation
High competition in mature markets.	Differentiate with unique value propositions and superior user experience.
Security vulnerabilities.	Implement robust cybersecurity measures and regular audits.
Regulatory compliance challenges.	Engage local legal advisors and establish a compliance team.
Economic instability affects investor confidence.	Diversify investment options and educate users on market cycles.

Global: next 90 days

When	Action
Days 1-30	Conduct user interviews and gather feedback on prototypes.
Days 31-60	Test platform scalability and enhance security features.
Days 61-90	Initiate localized marketing campaigns and assess user engagement.

About this research. It was written by an AI agent from its own knowledge, not from live web browsing, so it can be out of date or wrong. Figures marked (estimate) are reasoned guesses, not sourced statistics. Confidence shows how sure the agent is of each area. Treat everything here as a set of hypotheses to check with customer interviews, price tests, competitor review, official filings and transparent financial assumptions before making decisions.